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Education

- 2026 - PhD in Public Policy (Economics Track), **Harvard Kennedy School**
Academic Advisor: Prof. Desmond Ang
- 2024 - 2026 Pre-doctoral Fellow, **Dartmouth College**
Advisors: Prof. Elizabeth U. Cascio; Prof. Ethan G. Lewis
- 2020 - 2024 BA in Economics, **Amherst College**
Magna Cum Laude, with Distinction

Fields of Interest

Urban, Public, Economic History, Development

Peer-Reviewed Publications

- 2024 “On the cost-effectiveness of Nature-based Solutions for reducing disaster risk” (with Marta Vicarelli, Karen Sudmeier-Rieux, Ali Alsadadi, Simon Schutze, Michael M. Kang, Madeline Leue, David Wasielewski, and Jaroslav Mysiak), *Science of the Total Environment*, 947: 174524.
- 2023 “Climate Resilience in Coastal Massachusetts: A Survey of Municipal Challenges, Plans, and Needs” (with Marta Vicarelli, Robert DeConto, Darci Connor Maresca, Yu Ya Htut Tin, Madeline Leue, Mathew Barlow, Camille Barshers, Andy Danylchuk, Robert Darst, Jynessa Dutka-Gianelli, John Duff, Gavin Fay, Jill Fitzimmons, James Heiss, Kelly Hellman, Paul Kirshen, Katherine Kahl, Elizabeth Infield, Stratton Lloyd, Sheree Pagsuyoin, Meredith Rolfe, Eric Thomas, and Iren Valova), *MassBenchmarks*, 25: 2.

Other Academic Publications

- 2026 “The Birth of Mass Unauthorized Immigration in the United States” (with Elizabeth U. Cascio and Ethan G. Lewis), *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, 116: 337-343.
[coverage in [New York Times](#)]

Working Papers

“The Housing Impacts of the Community Preservation Act”
(solo-authored)

I examine the impact of local, supply-side policies on housing outcomes, including the supply and price of low-income housing and the racial composition of towns and cities. Specifically, I investigate Massachusetts’ Community Preservation Act (CPA), which allows municipalities to locally

generate funds through a surcharge on property taxes, with a level of matching funds from the state government, which can then be spent on affordable housing, open land preservation, recreation, and historic conservation. Exploiting variation in adoption timing since the policy's introduction in 2000, I utilize stacked event study models to identify the causal effects of CPA adoption. My analysis indicates that while the total number of new units does not increase following CPA adoption, production of housing shifts towards higher-density and rent-stabilized units. These effects are magnified in rural and economically-disadvantaged municipalities. I find that CPA adoption also leads to an increase in the white and Asian population share, with a corresponding decrease in the Latino and Black population share. Overall, this study provides insights into the benefits and costs of policies that are adopted and implemented entirely at the municipal level.

Works in Progress

“The Building Boom: Postwar School Construction and the Rise of Modern American Education”
(with Elizabeth U. Cascio and Ethan G. Lewis)

The immediate postwar period through the end of the 1950s was witness to massive school construction in the United States. Addressing mounting enrollment pressures and decades of unmet need, these new school facilities consolidated schools, met modern safety and sanitation standards, and incorporated features to enhance instruction. We examine whether these new schools raised educational attainment in the South, where existing school infrastructure was especially deficient, particularly for Black students. Using data from newly digitized state administrative reports and variation from state and locally financed school facilities programs in three southern states, we find suggestive evidence that Black school construction facilitated on-time Black continuation from first to second grade, which had long been a bottleneck on Black school progress. Effects were stronger in states that undertook explicit state-funded "equalization" efforts in the hopes of maintaining a fully segregated educational system. Black children with full exposure to state-financed school building programs saw improvements in adult educational attainment.

“Federal Immigration Enforcement and Local Immigration Sentiment”
(with Harufumi Nakazawa and Ariana Rodriguez)

How do natives develop political attitudes about immigration, including in areas with few immigrants? We explore the political consequences of bringing localities in contact with federal immigration policies by exploiting openings of an especially salient institution: ICE detention centers. Using a matched event study design, we estimate the effect of detention centers on the prominence and political slant of immigration in local discourse, as measured from news coverage and speeches by local representatives. We then test using individual-level surveys whether exposed community members develop sharper positions – both for and against – and place greater weight on immigration relative to other issues. Finally, we estimate effects on voter turnout and polarization in federal elections among affected counties. Findings shed light on how exposure to institutions can intensify local political engagement with immigration, amplifying existing partisan tendencies.

Policy Writings

- 2024 “Barriers to Democracy are Barriers to Housing: Strengthening Political Participation to Alleviate the Housing Crisis” (solo-authored), *Roosevelt Network Emerging Fellows Journal*, August 2024
- 2022 “Impacts of COVID-19 on Massachusetts Households: a Survey Analysis” (with Marta Vicarelli, Ali Alsadadi, Meredith Canada, Yu Ya Htut Tin, Anna Gishin, Madeline Leue, Elizabeth Murphy, and Yash Tyagi), *University of Massachusetts Amherst*, February 2022
- 2021 “Climate Resilience: a Survey of Massachusetts Municipalities” (solo-authored), *University of Massachusetts Amherst*, November 2021 [coverage in *Boston Globe*]

Invited Conference & Seminar Presentations

- 2025 - 2026 AEA 2026*, CESifo Economics of Education*
- 2023 - 2024 PIER Conference
- 2021 - 2022 PEDRR-United Nations Symposium*
- * *co-author presented*

Awards

- 2024 James R. Nelson Prize, Amherst College
for writing a distinguished honors thesis applying economic analysis to public policy
Sandy Rosenberg '72 Senior Grant, Amherst College
for a commitment to public service.
- 2023 The Economics Department Junior Class Prize, Amherst College
for a record of excellence in the study of economics.
- 2021 PEDRR Champion Award, PEDRR-United Nations Symposium
for meta-analysis of NBS.
- 2020 Top in Nepal, Cambridge International Education
for AS-Level Economics.

Teaching Experience

- 2025 - 2026 EC 68: Topics in Public Economics (*TA for Prof. Elizabeth Cascio; Spring Term*)
EC 67: Topics in Labor Economics (*TA for Prof. Ethan Lewis; Spring Term*)
- 2024 - 2025 EC 68: Topics in Public Economics (*TA for Prof. Elizabeth Cascio; Spring Term*)
EC 67: Topics in Labor Economics (*TA for Prof. Ethan Lewis; Spring Term*)
- 2021 - 2022 ECON 360: Econometrics (*TA & Grader for Prof. Katharine Sims; Spring Semester*)
CS 211: Data Structures (*Peer Tutor; Spring Semester*)
CS 121: Introduction to Computer Science II (*TA; Fall Semester*)

Relevant Employment

2023 - 2024 Roosevelt-in-Washington and Emerging Fellow, **Roosevelt Institute**
2021 - 2023 Research Assistant, **University of Massachusetts Amherst**
 PI: Prof. Marta Vicarelli, *Sustainable Policy Lab*
2022 Research Assistant, **Amherst College**
 PI: Prof. Mesay Gebresilassee
2022 Summer Intern, **Federal Reserve Bank of Boston**

Skills

Coding: Stata, Python, Java, R
Languages: English (native), Nepali (native), Hindi/Urdu (proficient), Spanish (intermediate)

References

Prof. Elizabeth U. Cascio (Department of Economics, Dartmouth College)
Prof. Ethan G. Lewis (Department of Economics, Dartmouth College)
Prof. Jessica W. Reyes (Department of Economics, Amherst College)
Prof. Marta Vicarelli (Department of Geography and Environment, London School of Economics)